The second part of rig controls is selecting and using the appropriate shapes to position and animate their character.

A few basic polygons and shapes that are used to create controls are:

- Spheres – help to rotate controls like neck, torso, and pelvis.
- Diamonds – help to move the legs and hands.
- Cubes – help to move the arms.
- Trapezoids – help move the knees and elbows.

Controls of a character

Rotation on one joint will alter the position and rotation of other parts as well. It happens because of the hierarchical organization of the controls.

For example, when you shape the top sections of the character, all other controls move. In a human character rig, controls that are higher in the hierarchy are more significant than the lower parts.

In a hierarchy, an object which is right over another object is known as the Parent, and the object below it is called the Child.

Joints

The aim of creating joints in animation is to express freedom of the character. When the joints are animated, the movement of the joints is affected. Hence, they are always arranged in a hierarchy from the beginning of character creation.

What is rigging?

The purpose of rigging is to create a bone structure of a 2D character or a 3D character. Before we understand how to rig a character, we first have to analyse the character model.

A few questions you have to ask for your character are:

- **What is the average pose of the character?**

A character's average pose is the usual pose among all the movements. Most often the average pose that animators use is T with the leg aiming forward and elbows aiming back that will give a 3D look to your character.

- **Is the character in the same frame?**

Significantly, your character is in the identical scene as other characters and items of the film.